



Argon gives off a blue-purple color when it is electrified.

Pure argon in a glass sphere

Fighting fire

Argon extinguishers are recommended for suppressing electrical fires. The gas does not damage expensive equipment by leaving a residue, making it a popular choice for fire extinguishers in server and data rooms, museums, archives, and laboratories.



Argon

18
Ar

This element's name comes from *argos*, the Greek word for "idle." True to its name, this gas almost never reacts with other elements, although scientists have managed to produce a compound of hydrogen, fluorine, and argon. Because it's fairly plentiful—making up about 1 percent of Earth's atmosphere—it's often used in food packaging, where it stops food from spoiling.

The blue argon laser targets the retina during eye surgery.



Non-invasive surgery

Laser surgical procedures do not make incisions, and, consequently, the affected area heals quickly. In the case of eye surgery, this blue argon laser can be used for a wide range of delicate operations on the retina.

Krypton

36
Kr

A colorless, odorless gas, krypton means "the hidden one" in Greek. It plays an important role in airport safety, as the flashing lights on most modern airport runways are filled with this gas, giving off very bright light. It is more reactive than the other noble gases—reacting with fluorine to produce krypton fluoride.



Krypton-powered airport runway lights

Oganesson

118
Og

Only a few atoms of this highly radioactive element have been made in a laboratory. As such, not much is known about it. Although oganesson falls into group 18 with the noble gases, scientists think it could be more reactive, and might be a solid at room temperature. Discovered by a group of Russian and American scientists in Dubna, Russia, the element is named after Yuri Oganessian, the leader of the team.

Russian scientist
Yuri Oganessian

